

The Boston Globe

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MONDAY, AUGUST 4, 2025

US, Israel consider ultimatum to Hamas

‘All or nothing’ deal would demand release of every hostage held in Gaza

By Isabel Kershner
and Aaron Boxerman
NEW YORK TIMES

JERUSALEM — For months, the Israeli government had focused on negotiating a two-phased deal for a 60-day cease-fire in the Gaza Strip and the release of some hostages, leaving discussions about a permanent end to the war for a later stage.

With the talks now at an impasse, US and Israeli officials ap-

pear to be sharply changing their tone by signaling that they will push for a comprehensive deal. But Israel and Hamas remain far apart, and analysts said this new approach would also face steep challenges.

The shift, at least in rhetoric, comes as the Israeli government faces rising domestic pressure to secure the release of hostages still held in Gaza. Israel believes that about 20 are still alive and that the

bodies of 30 others remain in the enclave. Videos released over the weekend showed two living captives looking emaciated and frail, shocking many Israelis and stirring fear among the hostages’ families.

► **3 Palestinian girls land in Boston, seek medical care in US. B1.**

The Israeli government has also come under mounting international criticism over the mass hunger that has spread through Gaza’s population of about 2 million people after Israel imposed strict restrictions in

recent months on the entry of aid.

Israel has continued launching military strikes on Gaza, even as it has facilitated the entry of more aid into Gaza in recent days. The Palestine Red Crescent Society said on Sunday that Israeli artillery had hit its offices in Khan Younis, killing one of the aid group’s staffers and injuring others.

Israel’s military told the Associated Press that it was reviewing the claim. The Red Cross called it an “outrage” that so many first responders have been killed in the

MIDEAST, Page A5

Alliance takes aim at primary care gap

Mass General Brigham, CVS seek OK to expand medical services at stores

By Jonathan Saltzman
GLOBE STAFF

Mass General Brigham, the state’s largest health care system, would join forces with CVS to expand primary care in Massachusetts, targeting areas with acute shortages of providers, according to plans recently filed with the state.

The partners hope to offer adult primary care at MinuteClinic, the small medical clinics inside CVS stores. The effort would encompass 37 CVS locations in regions such as Worcester and Bristol counties and Western Massachusetts.

About 80 nurse practitioners and physician associates employed by CVS would staff the clinics, according to the plans that MGB and CVS filed in June with the state Health Policy Commission. Each nurse practitioner or physician associate would oversee 1,500 patients, enabling the 80 employees to treat as many as 120,000 people statewide, according to MGB’s filing.

The clinics would join MGB’s network of providers, which means they could refer patients to MGB hospitals, specialists, diagnostic services, and laboratories if they needed follow-up care.

Most MinuteClinic sites currently offer limited

\$400 million
pledged by
MGB to invest
in primary
care over the
next five years

MGB CVS, Page A10

AI content may dominate 2026 election

Increasingly realistic videos and images alarm policymakers, watchdogs

By Sam Brodey
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — The video released by Democratic congressional hopeful Blake Gendebien last month looked, at first blush, eerily real: it depicted his potential rival, Representative Elise Stefanik of New York, dancing, posing with President Trump, and making a “shhhh” gesture with her index figure at her lips.

Except it wasn’t actually Stefanik doing any of those things. It was a version of Stefanik generated by artificial intelligence. A fine-print disclaimer at the end of the 45-second clip was the only explicit confirmation of how it was created.

The point of the video, Gendebien later told local press, was to satirically needle Stefanik for not-so-subtly maneuvering toward running for governor. Instead, the clip drew significant attention for its use of AI, with the Republican representative and her team slamming what she called a “deceitful” and “disgraceful AI digital ad” and local Democrats expressing discomfort with the

AI CAMPAIGN, Page A7



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

Red Sox right fielder Roman Anthony (right) scored against the Astros during the fourth inning at Fenway Park on Sunday in Boston’s 6-1 win over Houston, giving the Sox a series sweep. Pitcher Lucas Giolito delivered his longest start in four years, eight innings of one-run ball against the Astros, carrying the Red Sox to a fifth consecutive victory. **C1.**

Massachusetts should hire more public defenders, some say, amid the continuing crisis over pay for private bar advocates. **B1.**

A house in Cambridge is being offered for \$35 million, one of several on the market at eye-popping prices aimed at prestige-seeking super rich. **B1.**

Small grocery stores that depend on customers who use federal food stamp aid face a squeeze due to Republican cuts to the benefit program. **A2.**

The state has reduced winter electric rates for heat pump owners as regulators seek to lower a barrier to heating and cooling systems expected to play a key role in addressing climate change. **D1.**

As financial woes mount, colleges cut majors, angering students, professors

By Diti Kohli
GLOBE STAFF

In an era of higher education marked by cost-cutting and layoffs, some Massachusetts colleges are taking a dramatic step: Eliminating entire academic programs.

Berklee College of Music earlier this month said it will phase out its contemporary theater degree. Clark University is discontinuing majors in Ancient Civilization and Studio Art. Boston University will shutter satellite master’s programs in social work in Bedford, Fall River, and Cape Cod. And Lesley University in Cambridge has stopped enrolling students in its once-acclaimed creative writing master’s program.

It’s a sign of struggle at colleges when everything from federal funding to international student enrollment is up in the air. Administrators are more pessimistic about their schools’ financial outlooks, and lending agencies have soured on higher education at large. That’s on top of a recently increased tax on university endowments, changes to federal financial aid for students, and a downturn in the population of college-aged young adults in the coming years.

“If it was just international students, maybe colleges could make up the difference somewhere else,” said Sarah Spreitzer of the American Council on Education, which represents about

COLLEGE MAJORS, Page A10

‘The program has gone from different to a whole new world that we don’t know.’

CASSIE SEINUK
A professor at Lesley University on reductions to the school’s creative writing MFA program

Options run out for thousands of homeless families

With emergency funding for housing costs exhausted, many recipients now can’t pay rent

By Jade Lozada
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Nadine sat twisting her ring nervously. She was worried. Her lease for the apartment where she and her 4-year-old son had lived for the past year was ending in August, and she had nowhere to go.

Nadine, who immigrated to the United States from Haiti in 2021, has lived for a year in a Dorchester apartment subsidized by HomeBASE, a Massachusetts government-run program that has provided up to \$30,000 total in housing costs to more than 5,000 families who have exited emergency assistance shelters since 2023.

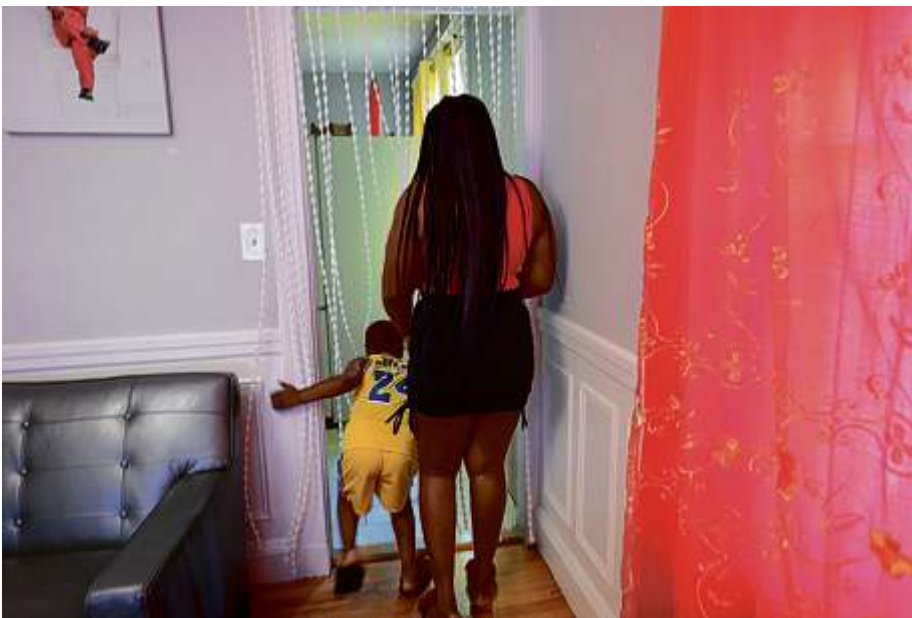
But the money disappears quickly for HomeBASE recipients like Nadine,

who use it to pay for costly moving expenses, such as a security deposit and furniture. With less money left over for rent, many HomeBASE families are forced to find their next housing before they have stable income or even a work permit. Nadine’s funds dried up just 10 months into the possible two-year rental subsidy.

HomeBASE has become a go-to option to move people from shelters, but shelter operators, nonprofits, and volunteer groups said they have had to get creative to make the program money stretch during a years-long process to help families become self-sufficient.

Nadine, an asylum-seeker who asked the Globe to withhold her last name be-

HOUSING, Page B4



SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

Nadine and her 4-year-old son in their subsidized Dorchester apartment.



It’s all a blur

Monday: Hazy sun.

High: 83-88. Low: 66-71.

Tuesday: Partly sunny.

High: 75-80. Low: 62-67.

Sunrise: 5:40. Sunset: 8:00.

Comics and Weather, **D4-5.**

Obituaries, **C9.**

VOL. 308, NO. 35

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Suggested retail price

\$4.00

